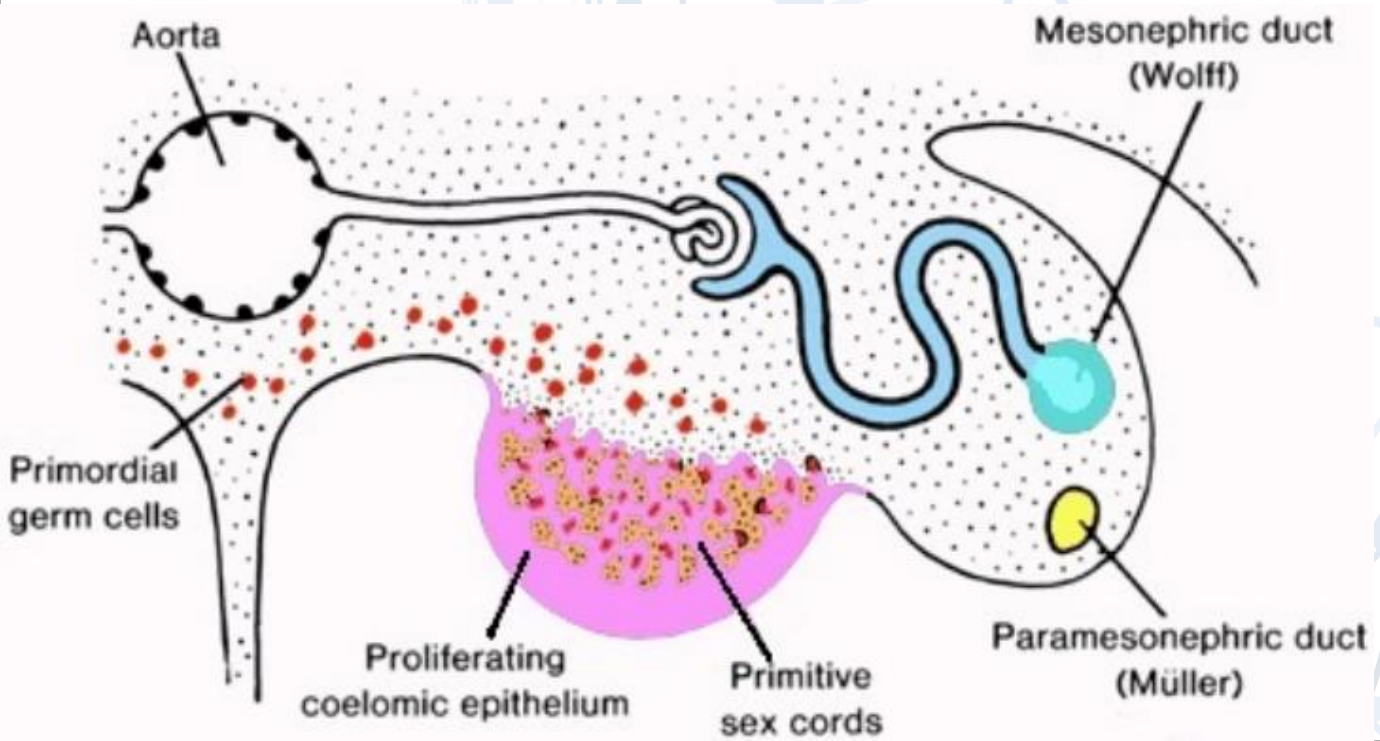
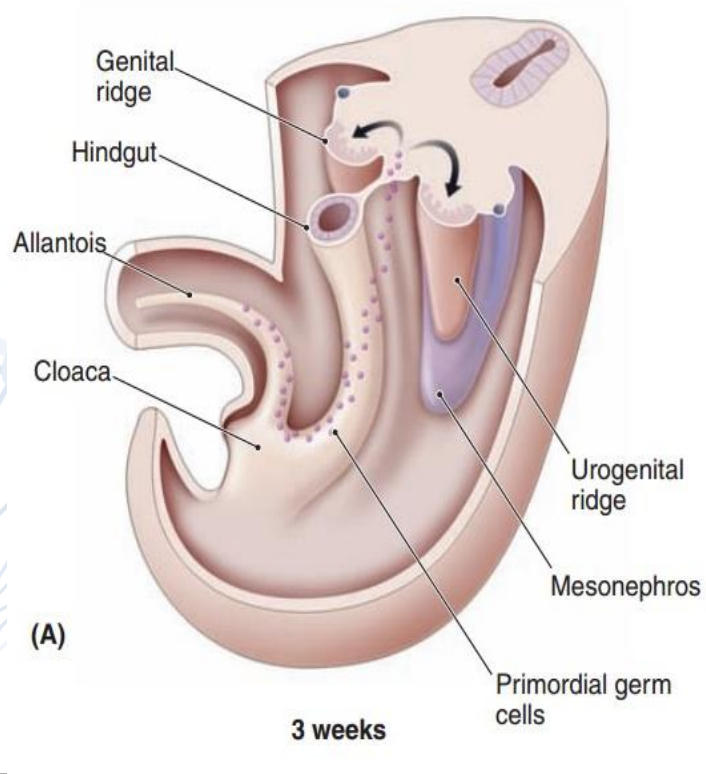
Development of the gonads

The Indifferent Embryo

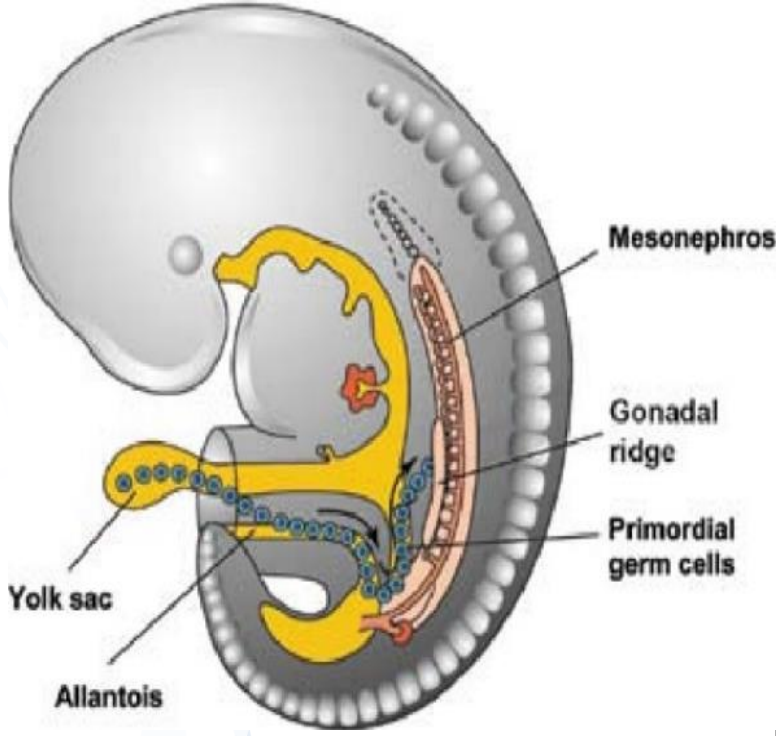
Gonads appear initially as a pair of longitudinal ridges known as the genital or gonadal ridges. They are formed by proliferation of the **coelomic epithelium** and a condensation of underlying **mesoderm** forming the primitive sex cords.





Development of the gonads

The Indifferent Embryo



Primordial germ cells (PGCs) :

- They originate from the wall of the yolk sac and migrate to invade the genital ridges and sex cords in the sixth week.

- The primordial germ cells have an **inductive influence** on development of the gonads

